

# Product Requirements Brief

Checkout reliability: a conditional brief to use only after the problem is corroborated.

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Independent portfolio prototype. All reviews, versions and analysis scenarios are fictional.

## Problem and evidence

In the synthetic sample, 14 of 17 payment reviews tagged version 5.2 are negative, compared with 2 of 11 payment reviews in other versions. Comments describe unclear payment outcomes, timeouts and repeated attempts. This is a signal for investigation, not proof of a release defect.

## Decision gate and assumptions

I would validate the signal against release changes, support contacts and checkout telemetry before approving a solution. I assume the fictional product has a booking and payment journey. The proposed requirements below are hypotheses, not requirements agreed with a real company.

## Users affected

Potentially, people completing a booking, returning from payment verification or retrying after an uncertain result. I would establish actual reach by platform, version, payment method and connection state. Review counts alone cannot establish it.

## Goal and non-goals

If validated, help users understand the payment outcome and recover safely from an interrupted checkout. Do not add payment methods, redesign the wider booking journey, automate refunds or commit a delivery date in this brief.

## User stories and proposed acceptance criteria

| Story                                                    | Observable acceptance criterion                                                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| As a customer, I want to know the outcome of my attempt. | For success, failure and pending responses, show a distinct state and a clear next step. A timeout must not be presented as confirmed failure. |
| As a customer, I want to retry without paying twice.     | Before retrying an uncertain attempt, reconcile its status. Repeated taps or retries for the same attempt must not create a second charge.     |
| As a customer, I want to keep my booking context.        | After an interrupted payment flow, preserve the relevant booking details and explain any expired availability.                                 |

## Validation before delivery

Use a test environment with synthetic transactions. Cover normal completion, declined response, timeout, app backgrounding, return from verification, offline recovery and repeated taps. Confirm each result across supported platforms and payment methods. No such integration or acceptance testing has occurred in ReviewPulse.

## Proposed success measures

| Measure                 | Definition / check                                                                                         |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Checkout completion     | Confirmed successful payments / eligible checkout attempts. Agree the attempt definition before measuring. |
| Uncertain outcomes      | Attempts with unresolved payment status / eligible attempts, with time-to-reconciliation.                  |
| Duplicate charge rate   | Confirmed duplicate charges for the same intended purchase / completed purchases.                          |
| Payment-related support | Payment support contacts relative to transaction volume, segmented by issue.                               |
| Recovery success        | Interrupted attempts safely completed after recovery / eligible interrupted attempts.                      |

I would establish baselines, agreed observation windows and guardrails before setting targets. A change in review sentiment alone would not prove that checkout reliability improved.

## Dependencies

Payment status and reconciliation capabilities, stable attempt identifiers, booking availability rules, event definitions, support taxonomy, QA test access, security review and engineering estimates. These are proposed dependencies, not existing ReviewPulse integrations.

## Open questions

Which step fails? What changed in the release? Do incidents and telemetry corroborate reviews? Which methods, devices and connection states are affected? Are errors understandable with assistive technology? What is the safest recovery action for a pending transaction?

## Next decision

If the evidence corroborates the problem, agree a focused problem statement with product, support and engineering, then refine the acceptance criteria and effort estimate. Otherwise, continue investigation or revise the hypothesis.